
White's choice -> your course reply

This is a repertoire map. An alternative is not labelled bad merely because the course chooses a different move.

NF3, BE2, O-O, D5

...e5, ...Nc6, ...Ne7; distinguish move nine | Booklet 02-05

7.DXE5 AGAINST ...E5

...dxe5; active queenless or open play | Booklet 06

7.D5 BEFORE O-O

...a5 and flexible ...Na6 development | Booklet 07

7.BE3 AGAINST ...E5

...Ng4 and a concrete bishop decision | Booklet 08

F3: SAMISCH

Panno ...Nc6/...a6/...Rb8; react to d5 | Booklet 09-10

F4: FOUR PAWNS

...c5 and ...e6; know the Benoni transition | Booklet 11

BE2 AND BG5: AVERBAKH

...c5 and ...e6 against the center | Booklet 12

H3: MAKOGONOV

...O-O, ...e5 and ...Na6 after d5 | Booklet 13

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G3 AND BG2: FIANCHETTO

Core ...Nbd7/...e5/...c6 | Booklet 14

OPTIONAL SECOND FIANCHETTO REPERTOIRE

Panno ...Nc6/...a6/...Rb8 | Booklet 15

EARLY BISHOPS, NGE2 OR H4

Respond to the exact threat and center | Booklet 16

E3 RATHER THAN E4

Develop, then challenge with ...e5 | Booklet 17

1.C4 OR 1.NF3

Transpose only when the pawn center matches | Booklet 18

LONDON, TORRE, COLLE

Companion central defenses; no automatic KID | Booklet 19

2.BG5 OR 2.NC3

...Ne4 or ...d5 companion repertoire | Booklet 20

Where the standard setup is appropriate

START WITH 1...Nf6

Against 1.d4, the course begins 1...Nf6. After 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4, play ...d6 to support the center. Against 3.Nf3 or 3.g3, develop the bishop and wait to see whether White builds e4 or a Fianchetto.

DO NOT CONFUSE A DELAY WITH A REFUSAL

White can postpone Nc3, e4 or d4 and transpose later. Keep a record of the actual piece squares. If White reaches the same position with the same side to move and rights, use the relevant chapter.

THE C6 KNIGHT CREATES A COMMITMENT

...Nc6 is excellent in the Classical and Panno plans, but d5 attacks it. Before choosing ...Nc6, know the retreat: often e7 in the closed Classical, sometimes e5 in a Samisch, and a5 in the Fianchetto Panno.

THE D7 KNIGHT CREATES A DIFFERENT COMMITMENT

...Nbd7 supports e5 and keeps c6 available for a pawn. It can obstruct the c8 bishop and occupy a square wanted by Nf6. You must arrange the pieces accordingly; the same knight maneuver cannot be copied blindly.

When to leave the King's Indian script

2.BG5: TROMPOWSKY

The early bishop attacks or threatens to exchange Nf6 before the normal c4 center appears. The course answers ...Ne4 and then develops centrally. Playing ...g6 is not declared universally bad; it is simply not the selected answer to this different opening.

2.NC3: THE PIRC BOUNDARY

After 1.d4 Nf6 2.Nc3 g6 3.e4 d6, you have a Pirc-type position, not a King's Indian with c4. This course chooses 2...d5 and gives Veresov and Jobava companion lines, so you do not need a full Pirc repertoire here.

1.E4: OUTSIDE THIS COURSE

You need a separate answer to 1.e4. The King's Indian Defense is not a universal system that can be played unchanged against every first move. A Pirc or Modern repertoire would be a separate project with its own theory.

LONDON AND ENGLISH

White can refuse the broad d4/c4/e4 center without doing anything wrong. Your task is to choose an appropriate central challenge. Booklets 18-20 give practical companion lines for these branches.

Choose the central break deliberately

...E5

This directly challenges d4. If White plays d5, you may get the familiar locked chain. If White exchanges, prioritize piece activity. Ensure the pawn and resulting recaptures survive pins and queen exchanges.

...C5

This attacks d4 from the flank and often creates a Benoni structure after d5 and ...e6. It is the main course answer to the Four Pawns Attack and Averbakh. It can also create an open bind if White exchanges the d-pawn.

...D5

This can equalize or free Black when fully prepared, particularly in open or Fianchetto structures. It is not the defining early move of the standard KID repertoire; an early ...d5 against Nc3 can instead enter a Grunfeld.

...F5

This attacks e4 and can start a kingside initiative. First clear f6, support the center and check White's king position. Against the Fianchetto or a fluid center, the same move may create weaknesses without a useful attack.